SPORTS MEDIA CAMPAIGN · TEAM 6

MORE THAN A PROP

National Responsible Fandom Week · October 19–25, 2026

A campaign with the NBPA and Tyrese Haliburton confronting bettor harassment of athletes and the rise of problem gambling among young fans.

Joseph Sullivan · Joseph Tarlin · Taniyah Thompson · Ari Kirschbaum

Sports Communication · Final Group Project · Week 6

Campaign Overview

The 30-second version

More Than a Prop is a week-long national campaign launched with the National Basketball Players Association and Indiana Pacers guard Tyrese Haliburton during the opening week of the 2026–27 NBA season. It reframes the sports-gambling conversation away from the scandals and towards the people it impacts the most. The betting boom has hurt the athlete who is reduced to a stat line, and the young fan who quietly loses money they do not have. Across seven days we will pair player-voiced social content with a Miami community event, campus tour stops, and a clear call to action. You can text the national helpline, or take the "Fan Not Gambler" pledge. Our mission begins with this line: An athlete is a person, not a parlay leg. Our success will be measured in reach, earned coverage, pledges signed, and helpline volume.

THE CAUSE

Gambling-driven harassment of athletes and youth gambling harm

THE ASK

Take the pledge at morethanaprop.org

Help line: text 800GAM

Why Now

Sports betting stopped being a side story in October 2025

OCT 2025	Federal indictments name Miami Heat guard Terry Rozier and Trail Blazers coach Chauncey Billups among 34 people charged across two gambling probes.
OCT 2025	The NBA opens a league-wide review of its betting-integrity and player-protection policies days after the arrests.
MAR 2026	Defendants return to federal court in Brooklyn; the case stays in national headlines through March Madness.
2026	Problem-gambling diagnoses are up more than 60% in states that legalized sports betting — rates doubled among 18–29 year olds.

Source: CNN · The Athletic · Sports Business Journal

The Numbers Behind the Cause

Four statistics that carry the entire campaign

48%

of Division I athletes surveyed in 2026 reported experiencing abuse, with betting-driven abuse among the most common forms.

36%

of D-I men's basketball players reported betting-related social media abuse in a single year.

+60%

increase in problem-gambling diagnoses in states that legalized sports betting; rates doubled for ages 18–29.

+138%

jump in Florida problem-gambling helpline calls about online gambling since 2023.

Source: Covers/NCAA · NCAA · SBJ · Tampa Bay Times

Who We Are Working With

One athlete voice, one union, one clinical partner

TYRESE HALIBURTON

CAMPAIGN FACE

The Pacers guard already said it out loud: "To half the world, I'm just helping them make money on DraftKings. I'm a prop." That line is the campaign.

ROLE IN THE WEEK

Hero film, one podcast sit-down, and the Thursday campus panel.

NBPA

INSTITUTIONAL PARTNER

The players' union has publicly stated that prop bets have become "an increasingly alarming source of player harassment, both online and in person."

ROLE IN THE WEEK

Recruits the ten players for "Read My Mentions" and opens union channels.

NCPG

RESOURCE PARTNER

The National Council on Problem Gambling supplies the helpline, clinician referrals, and vetted educational material for every campaign asset.

ROLE IN THE WEEK

Staffs the Miami screening booth and validates every stat we publish.

Source: Sports Illustrated · ESPN

Target Audience

Primary, secondary, and the people we need in the room

PRIMARY

Men 18-34 who bet on sports

- Heaviest users of same-game parlays and player props
- The fastest-growing group for problem-gambling diagnoses
- Overwhelmingly reached on X, TikTok, Reddit, and sports podcasts
- Also the group producing most bettor harassment of athletes
- Concentrated on college campuses and in legal-betting metros

SECONDARY

College athletes, athletic departments, and campus wellness staff — the people absorbing the abuse and the ones positioned to intervene.

TERTIARY

Parents of high-school athletes, state regulators, and sportsbook compliance teams — the audiences that convert awareness into policy change.

Executional Plan · The Seven Days

October 19–25, 2026 — NBA opening week

MON 10/19	**Launch**	Haliburton first person video drops across NBPA and player channels at 9 a.m. ET. Embargoed exclusive breaks same morning.
TUE 10/20	**"Read My Mentions"**	Ten NBA and WNBA players read real betting-abuse messages sent to them on camera. Cut into 15s, 30s, and 60s versions.
WED 10/21	**The Data Drop**	NCPG and campaign release a joint one page fact sheet plus shareable infographics on youth gambling harm.
THU 10/22	**Campus Stop**	Panel at Florida International University with a D-I athlete, a clinician, and a recovered bettor. Live Streamed and clipped.
FRI 10/23	**Miami Event**	"Fan Not Gambler" night at a Miami rec center: free youth clinic, on-site NCPG screening booth, pledge wall, local media availability.
SAT-SUN	**Pledge Push**	Influencer and podcast wave drives traffic to morethanaprop.org. Week closes with a recap reel and a total pledge count.

Target Outlets and Influencers

Ten targets across national, business, local, and creator tiers

OUTLET / INFLUENCER	TIER	WHY THEM
ESPN — Outside the Lines	National	Owns the betting-integrity beat; embargoed exclusive target
The Athletic	National	Long-form appetite; already covering the federal cases
Sports Business Journal	Trade	Reaches league, union, and sportsbook decision-makers
Front Office Sports	Trade	Fast-turn newsletter with a young industry readership
Miami Herald	Local	Anchors the Friday community event coverage
WPLG Local 10 Miami	Local TV	Broadcast b-roll from the youth clinic and pledge wall
Pablo Torre Finds Out	Podcast	Investigative sports podcast; ideal Haliburton sit-down
The Pat McAfee Show	Podcast	Reaches the exact 18–34 male bettor we are targeting
Bomani Jones (The Right Time)	Commentary	Credible critic of gambling's creep into sports media
@overtime / @houseofhighlights	Social	Distribution engines for the vertical athlete-read clips

Media Pitch Email

Sent to our target outlets and influencers the morning of October 19

SUBJECT: "I'm a prop." Haliburton and the National Basketball Players Association launch a week on what betting culture does to athletes

Hi [organization/entity],

Ten months after federal indictments pulled an NBA head coach and an active player into a gambling scandal, the league's players are making their own move, and it is unrelated to fixing the actual game.

On Monday, October 19, the NBPA and Pacers guard Tyrese Haliburton launch More Than a Prop, the first National Responsible Fandom Week. The campaign centers two costs of the betting boom that rarely get covered: the harassment athletes take from angry bettors, and the increase of gambling-problem diagnoses among 18-to-29-year-olds in states that legalized sports betting.

It will first be released 9 a.m. ET Monday, but I can offer a first look at the campaign film, a 20-minute Haliburton interview, an NBPA leadership interview, and unreleased National Council on Problem Gambling helpline data.

Would later this week work for an introduction call? I can send the information today!

Best,
Joe, Joe, Ari, & Taniyah

Key Performance Indicators

Targets set before launch, reported 30 days after

50M

Total impressions

Earned, owned, and influencer combined

25

Pieces of official coverage

Media publicly available via outlets with easy access.

60

Social media-related posts published

Across NBPA, team, athlete, and partner accounts

8%

Engagement rate

Against a 3% sports-nonprofit benchmark

20K

Pledges signed

Verified sign-ups at morethanaprop.org

+15%

NCPG helpline volume

Week-over-week lift during campaign week

Measurement and Success

Daily — Meltwater clip report: pulls list of clips together that matches key search terms related to media and news on gambling

Weekly — Share-of-voice against the baseline gambling-scandal news cycle, metric that shows what percent of a total conversation/attention to a specific issue is relative to everything else discussed in the gambling world

Day 30 — Full slide deck sent to NBPA: media coverage tier breakdown, assessment of the tone of that coverage, data on who made a pledge related to the campaign, and NCPG helpline data

Day 90 — Follow-up survey of the resources used and their effectiveness

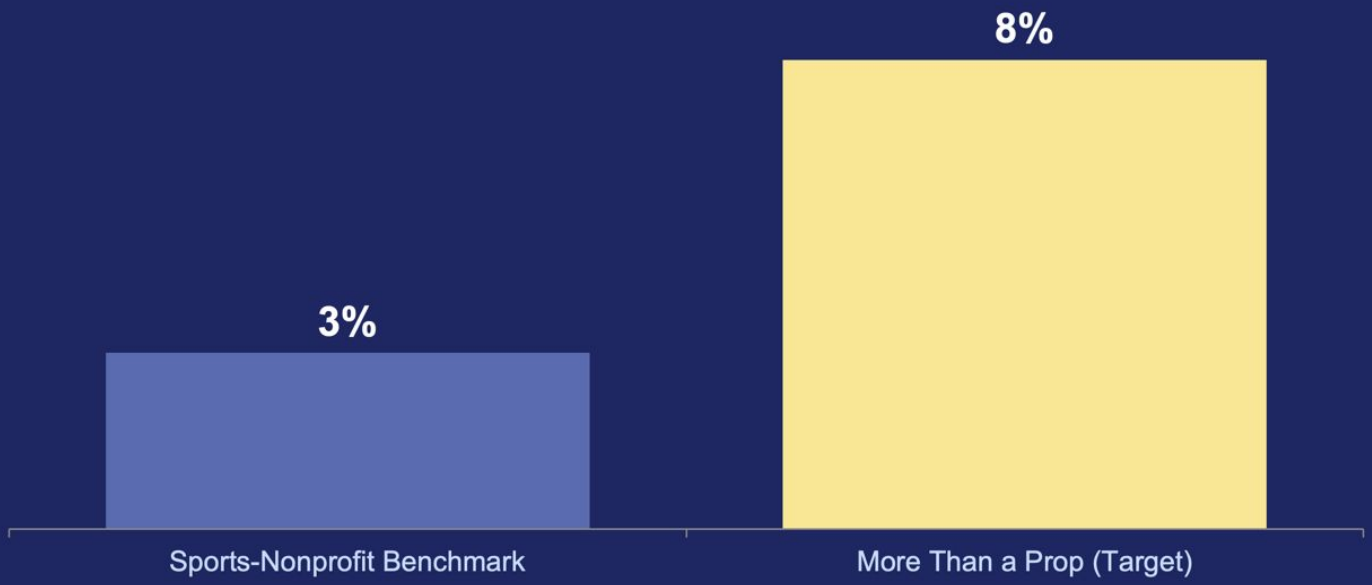
THE REAL WIN

A repeatable annual week that any league, union, or athletic department can run where the gambling problem is controlled.

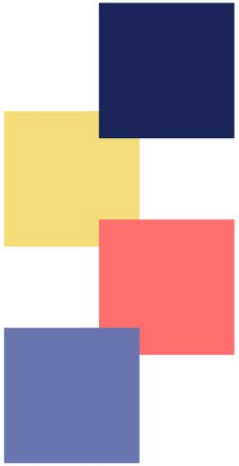
An athlete is a person, not a parlay leg.

Beating the Benchmark

Projected campaign engagement rate vs. the sports-nonprofit industry standard



A 2.7x lift over benchmark is the target — driven by athlete-voiced content and the Friday Miami event.



The End

An athlete is a person, not a parlay leg.

Thank you — questions welcome

morethanaprop.org